

Zach Hewett

London, UK
zacharyhewett1@gmail.com

Online Portfolio:

zachhewett.github.io/portfolio

I design lighting that guides the player's eye and anchors the mood of a game. With five years of experience on EVE Vanguard, Need for Speed and Star Citizen, I balance cinematic artistry with technical precision. I build the tools and workflows that keep art pipelines moving and help teams meet their deadlines.

Optimisation is crucial. I work closely with rendering engineers to push visual quality while hitting strict performance targets. This ranges from tricks of the trade to hide light lod-ing behaviour all the way to deep scalability settings optimisation and custom tech iteration.

Experience

Lighting Artist
CCP Games

Dec 2022 - Present

- The sole lighting artist on the EVE Vanguard project, working closely with the Art Director and Game Director to deliver a bold, cinematic experience that facilitates fast-paced FPS gameplay.
- Overseeing the project transition to Unreal Engine 5, optimising for Lumen and Virtual Shadowmaps, to achieve a smooth 60 fps experience on target hardware.

Associate Lighting Artist
Criterion Games

Jan 2022 - Dec 2022

Responsible for lighting large sections of the game's open world environment, from initial creative exploration through to final optimisation and bug fixing

- Team specialist in our novel, in house GI solution, working closely with rendering engineers to solve problems, improve GI quality and streamline the workflow for artists

Lighting Artist I
Cloud Imperium Games

Feb 2021 - Jan 2022

- Responsible for translating concept art into in-engine environment lighting. Including interiors, exteriors and atmosphere/sky lighting
- I worked on a number of releases for this project in styles ranging from grand, spaceship showrooms to gritty forges in the asteroid belts of contested areas

Realtime Lighting Artist
Nexus Studios

Oct 2020 - Feb 2021

- Working closely with Technical Artists to reproduce stylized art direction in a PBR-focused game engine.

Education

University for the Creative Arts - Master of Arts Degree
Games Design - Distinction

Graduated 2020

University of the Arts London - Bachelor of Arts Degree
Film Practice - 1st Class Honours

Graduated 2019